

MAN EVERYWHERE IS A DISTURBING AGENT

HUMAN DEVASTATION OF EARTH

IN CONTEXT

KEY FIGURE

George Perkins Marsh (1801–82)

BEFORE

1824 Joseph Fourier describes the greenhouse effect—later identified as a contributing factor in global warming.

1830s Scientists posit that the Dutch colonization of Mauritius in the 17th century caused the dodo to become extinct.

AFTER

1962 In the US, Rachel Carson's *Silent Spring* describes the harmful effect of pesticides on the environment.

1988 The Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC) is set up to assess the "risk of human-induced climate change."

2012 The Intergovernmental Science–Policy Platform on Biodiversity and Ecosystem Services (IPBES) is set up.

The widely held view that the natural world existed to be exploited by humankind saw a major rebuttal in the form of the 19th-century environmental movement. Arguments against the "imperial" attitude to